LONE ROCK POINT

ASSESSMENT REPORT

OVERALL MODERNIZATION SCORE

2.84 / 5.0

Content: **2.40** (48%) · Design: **3.10** (62%) · Accessibility: **3.91** (78%) · Security: **1.80** (36%) · User Centric Design: **3.00** (60%)

ASSESSED URL	ASSESSMENT DATE	PAGES ASSESSED
https://ndstudio.gov	April 24, 2026	21 pages
MODERNIZATION STAGE	**REPORT TYPE**	**ASSESSMENTS INCLUDED**
Defined	Content, Design, Accessibility, Security, User Centric Design Assessments	5 Assessments Included

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

CONTENT

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Plain Language & Readability	2.80 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
Freshness / One Answer	1.70 / 5.0	LOW	>= 3.5
Content Governance	1.40 / 5.0	LOW	>= 3.5
LEP / Translation	1.60 / 5.0	LOW	>= 3.5
Duplication	2.70 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
Authority & Trust	4.50 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5

DESIGN / UX

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Governance & Policies	3.20 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
User Experience	4.00 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Communication Tone	4.10 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Brand Identity	3.90 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5

ACCESSIBILITY

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Visual & Adaptability	4.00 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Structure & Navigation	3.06 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
Forms, Links & Language	4.01 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Contrast & Color	4.72 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Keyboard & Interaction	3.16 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
Cognitive Support	5.00 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Media Accessibility	3.40 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5

SECURITY

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Encrypt in Transit	3.80 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Authentication	0.40 / 5.0	LOW	>= 3.5
Vulnerability Disclosure	0.00 / 5.0	LOW	>= 3.5
Third-party Resources	2.90 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5

USER CENTRIC DESIGN

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Strategy and Audience	3.53 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Visual Design - Typography	3.97 / 5.0	GOOD	>= 3.5
Visual Design - Layout and Media	3.30 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
Navigation	3.43 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5
Trust and Contact	1.07 / 5.0	LOW	>= 3.5

CRITERIA	SCORE	STATUS	BENCHMARK
Analytics and Performance	3.00 / 5.0	NORMAL	>= 3.5

FINDINGS & ACTION PLAN

CRITICAL FINDINGS

5 items

01 [Security: Vulnerability Disclosure] No vulnerability disclosure policy detected.
No VDP path or policy link found.

02 [User Centric Design: Trust and Contact] No privacy policy page detected
No accessible privacy policy link was found. Paths checked: https://ndstudio.gov/privacy

03 [Content: Plain Language] Reading level is Grade 13.3 — far above the Grade 6-8 target
Flesch-Kincaid: 13.3, Gunning Fog: 17.1

04 [Design: USWDS Compliance] USWDS official website banner not detected
Gov sites should display 'An official website of the United States government'

05 [Accessibility: Accessibility] First focusable element is not a skip link
{'tag': 'a', 'href': '/', 'text': 'National Design Studio', 'label': ''}

ELEVATED FINDINGS

5 items

01 [Security: Transport Security] HSTS header is missing.
Strict-Transport-Security not found.

02 [User Centric Design: Analytics and Performance] Error recovery signals are incomplete
Recovery checks found mixed or weak signals. Broken sampled links: 0. Form error containers detected: no. Custom 404 page detected: no.

03 [Content: Plain Language] Average syllables per word is 1.90 (target: ≤1.6)
188 syllables in 99 words

04 [Design: USWDS Compliance] Limited USWDS component usage (0 unique classes)
Classes found: none

05 [Accessibility: Accessibility] **Auto-playing content lacks pause control**
Autoplay detected without accessible stop/pause button

ROUTINE FINDINGS

5 items

01 [Security: Third-party Resources] **Permitted dynamic services detected (informational only).**
2 permitted dynamic service(s) were detected. Informational - permitted services are not penalized. Detected services: - cdn.infra.ndstudio.gov: https://cdn.infra.ndstudio.gov/internal-analytics/script.js (Analytics (Permitted)) - static.cloudflareinsights.com: https://static.cloudflareinsights.com/beacon.min.js/v8c78df7c7c0f484497ecbca7046644da1771523124516 (Analytics (Permitted))

02 [User Centric Design: Typography] **Typography text sizing baseline captured**
Text-size score: 5.0 / 5. Body average: 16.0px. Paragraph average: 28.8px. List average: 0.0px. Heading averages - H1: 56.0px, H2: 100.0px, H3: 28.0px. Visible elements below 12px: 0. Scoring note: Body and heading text sizes are within a comfortable readable range..

03 [Content: Governance] **No visible skip-to-main-content link detected**
A skip link helps keyboard and screen reader users bypass repeated navigation.

04 [Design: Banner Centralization] **No legal/cookie/compliance banner detected on this page**
Pages should consistently display required compliance banners

05 [Accessibility: Accessibility] **Jargon term may be unclear: design & engineering (WCAG 3.1.3)**
Plain alternative: planning and building

ACTION PLAN

PHASE 01 - IMMEDIATE

Launch a 30-day stabilization sprint across content, design, accessibility, security, and user centric design, with highest priority on Vulnerability Disclosure, Authentication, and Trust and Contact. Sequence work by risk: first user-blocking issues, then compliance gaps, then quality improvements. Assign a weekly remediation owner, publish a short issue log, and verify fixes against the exact pages referenced in this report.

Deliverables: fixed high-severity findings; corrected outdated/ambiguous public-facing copy; accessibility barriers removed from core journeys; baseline QA checklist adopted by content and design owners.

PHASE 02 - LONG-TERM

After stabilization, move into a 60- to 90-day modernization phase focused on governance and repeatability. Convert one-off fixes into standards: component patterns, page templates, publishing guardrails, and editorial review gates.

Deliverables: measurable KPI dashboard, monthly quality audits, reusable design/content standards, and an operating cadence that keeps scores improving release over release.